

The 62nd Annual

ASBURY PARK

Polar Bear Races

JANUARY 3RD, 2026

shoreac.org

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SHORE ATHLETIC CLUB OF NEW JERSEY

"Promoting the Olympic Sport of Track and Field Since 1934"

Our Olympians

Elliott Denman
Barbara Friedrich
Bob Mimm
Bill Reilly
Dave Romansky
Todd Scully
Maren Seidler
Jim Wooding

A WELCOME FROM THE SHORE ATHLETIC CLUB PRESIDENT

Welcome to one of the Shore Athletic Club's signature event, The Asbury Park Polar Bear Races. We hope you enjoy what our event has to offer: flat 1 mile and 5k courses with professional timing, a highly competitive field, distinctive awards, and the rich historical ambience of Asbury Park, New Jersey.

This year's event is the result of hard work by our Race Directors, not to mention our event staff, volunteers, first responders, sponsors, club members and everyone involved in making this event a great success.

We aim to follow the great Shore A.C. tradition of offering an event where everyone has a chance to compete. This year we will see a large, competitive field of participants; all enjoying what we hope to be a beautiful December morning at the Jersey Shore.

Our National Champions

John Borican
Ray Funkhouser
Dick Ganslen
Elmore Harris
Herb McKenley
Cliff Mimm
Eulace Peacock
Blaine Rideout
Andy Stanfield
Josh Williamson

We hope that you enjoy the 62nd Annual Asbury Park Polar Bear Races!

Best wishes and good luck to all.

Erin O'Neill
President
Shore Athletic Club of New Jersey



SCHEDULE OF EVENTS

FRIDAY, DECEMBER 26TH, 2025

 **THE OUTPOST RUNNING AND WALKING CO.**

32 CHURCH ST, LITTLE SILVER, NJ 07739

4:00PM - 6:00PM: EARLY BIRD BIB AND T-SHIRT PICKUP

SATURDAY, JANUARY 3RD, 2026

 **ASBURY PARK CONVENTION HALL**

1300 OCEAN AVE N, ASBURY PARK, NJ 07712

8:00AM - 9:30AM: BIB AND T-SHIRT PICKUP*

9:30AM - 1 MILE START

10:00AM - 5K RACE START

AWARDS CEREMONY TO FOLLOW**

***FIRST 500 RUNNERS TO PICK UP THEIR BIB WILL RECEIVE A COMMEMORATIVE
RACE T-SHIRT**

****AWARDS CEREMONY WILL BE HELD AS SOON AS RESULTS ARE MADE AVAILABLE
IN CONVENTION HALL. AWARDS WILL BE AVAILABLE FOR PICK UP, THEY WILL NOT
BE MAILED.**

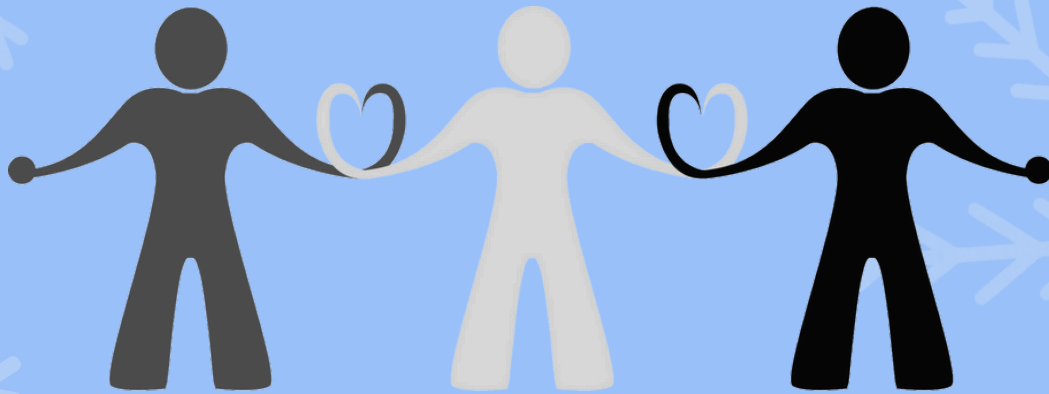


BE SURE TO CHECK OUT OUR VENDORS IN CONVENTION HALL!



CHARITY PARTNER

THE SHORE AC IS PROUD TO PARTNER WITH



Interfaith **Neighbors**

Neighbors Helping Neighbors

FOR THE 2025 ASBURY PARK POLAR BEAR RACES

COMMUNITY FOOD DONATION

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[INTERFAITHNEIGHBORS.ORG](https://interfaithneighbors.org)

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COURSE MAP



Asbury Park Polar Bear Races

NEW 5K COURSE

10:00 AM start

Start line: Outside Robinson Ale House on the boardwalk

Head south 1.55 miles on the boards to Bradley Beach

Turnaround and run 1.55 miles back on the boards to finish outside Robinson Ale House in Asbury Park

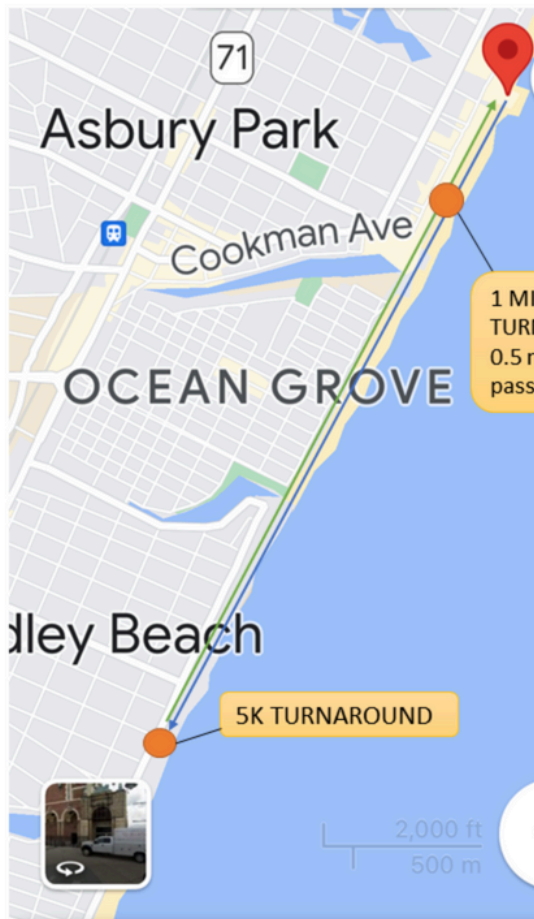
1 MILE COURSE

9:30 AM start

Start line: Outside Robinson Ale House on the boardwalk

Head south .50 miles on the boards to the Casino

Turnaround and run .5 miles back on the boards to the finish outside Robinson Ale House in Asbury Park



MEN'S ALL-TIME TOP 10 PERFORMANCES

5K RUN

1. Robert Pederson, 2023 - 14:47
2. Matt Lepine, 2024 - 15:09
3. Brian Hill, 2024 - 15:11
4. Robert Pederson, 2021 - 15:14
5. Marty Liquori, 1975 - 15:23
6. Michael Zurzolo, 2023 - 15:24
7. Vince Cartier, 1975 - 15:25
8. Michael Bond, 2023 - 15:26
9. Harold Nolan, 1975 - 15:27
10. Brian Hill, 2023 - 15:28

5 MILE RUN (1977-2013)

1. Ray Cerenkowski, 1982 - 24:35
2. Harold Nolan, 1977 - 24:40
3. Bryon Pownall, 1987 - 24:48
4. Buck Logan, 1980 - 24:50
5. Tom Aspal, 1978 - 24:51
6. Bill Scholl, 1981 - 24:51
7. Chris Halliman, 1979 - 24:53
8. Eric Savoth, 2003 - 24:53
9. Hugh Kuchka, 1983 - 25:01
10. Dave Billings, 1981 - 25:10



WOMEN'S ALL-TIME TOP 10 PERFORMANCES

5K RUN

1. Kerry Dyke, 2019 - 17:35
2. Amanda Marino, 2016 - 17:41
3. Lisa Wilehim, 2006 - 17:58
4. Kerry Dyke, 2024 - 18:02
5. Emma McGill, 2025 - 18:05
6. Beth Meyer, 2018 - 18:12
7. Amanda Huneke, 2022 - 18:26
8. Nicolette Mateescu, 2023 - 18:31
9. Erika Flores, 2022 - 18:42
10. Kiera Russo, 2024 - 18:51
11. Casey Hopkins, 2022 - 18:51

5 MILE RUN (1977-2013)

1. Alicia Kelly, 1995 - 28:27
2. Lauren Rhafigan, 2007 - 28:40
3. Lindsey Gallo, 2004 - 28:56
4. Meg Waldron, 1977 - 29:45
5. Brenda Sanders, 1977 - 30:07
6. Lauren Adams, 2001 - 30:19
7. Allison Linnell, 2010 - 30:19
8. Linda Wolf, 1996 - 30:22
9. Barbara Addis, 1992 - 30:26
10. Joyce Jarrowski, 1991 - 31:07



A LOOK BACK IN HISTORY

THE FIRST EVER ARTICLE OF THE FIRST EVER ASBURY PARK POLAR BEAR RACES IN 1964

FIND MORE ARTICLES
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WWW.SHOREAC.ORG

McDonnell, Daniel Victors In Boardwalk 'Polar' Races

ASBURY PARK — Neither rain nor wind nor a very slippery boardwalk interfered with the swift completion of their appointed rounds by a band of 49 hardy trackmen competing in the city's first Polar Bear Track Carnival yesterday.

These 49 obviously weren't looking for a white Christmas—they had track shoes but no gloves.

John McDonnell, a former 1.5-mile champion now living in New York, captured the opening event on the program—the 5,000-meter run—in a clock of 16 minutes, 7.5 seconds and was rated excellent under the conditions.

Don Daniel, a Long Island College student, was the day's second winner, taking the 10-minute walking race in one hour, 13 minutes, 13 seconds.

Thirty-four started the run and finished. Seventeen started the walk and went the route in the walk. Two Brick Township residents postman Bob Carlson and high school student Ed Tompkins—both iron man duty by completing both races.

McDonnell Beats Best
McDonnell, who has a 4:02 mile to his credit, had a 150-yard lead on his nearest rival, engineer Fred Best of Somerset. Best trailed John Dzelzkalns, Rutgers University senior from New Brunswick, for half of the race, but then blazed by and had a 100-yard edge at the end.

Ed Shattuck, Central Regional High School's NJSIAA Group III cross-country champion from Lakehurst, put on a powerful drive down the last straightaway and just missed catching the eased-up Dzelzkalns.

Shattuck led home a strong collection of Shore schoolboy stars. Red Bank Catholic's Bob Byron was fifth, Long Branch's Tom Bazley sixth, Middletown's Harry Nolan eighth, CBA's Mike Mirarchi and Don Rowe ninth and 10th. Middletown's Bernie Terhune 13th, Central Regional's Joe Callahan 14th, Asbury Park's Tom Hutchison and Harold Suggs 17th and 18th, Middletown's Bill Such 19th, and Brick Township's Bill Darnell 21st.

Collegians home for the holidays were ex-Keyport High ace Ed Scullion, now a sophomore at Murray, Ky. State College, and Ugo Kuhl.

worth, Long Branch High School senior, was seventh, with four Ocean County walkers. Ken Elith, Carlson, Fred Spector and Tompkins, occupying the 14 to 17 places.

The Penn A.C. edged the New York Pioneer Club by a single point for the walking team title.

Other clubs represented in the meet were the United A.A. and Millrose A.A., both of New York, and the Central Jersey Track Club.

Asbury Park city councilman Frank H. Rowland was on hand to present trophies to the top finishers. George Zuckerman and Sherman Mischler served on the city's organizing committee.

Officiating were Bill Brouillette, Brick Township cross-country coach; Dick Steadman and Art Oberg of the Monmouth College coaching staff; John Stehli, Central Jersey Track Club, and Jim Borden, United A.A.

Medals, Trophies Given

Trophies went to the top three men in each race and medals were awarded to other leading finishers.

Watching the run and wishing he was in it was Joe Lynch of Highlands, the ICA cross-country champion from Georgetown. AAU competition for

Georgetown students is temporarily off-limits, pending a resolution of the AAU-NCAA feud.

5000-METER RUN

1. John McDonnell, NYAC (16:07.5); 2. Fred Best, Somerset (16:37.5); 3. John Dzelzkalns, New Brunswick (17:35); 4. Ed Shattuck, Lakehurst (17:50); 5. Bob Byron, Red Bank (17:53); 6. Tom Bazley, Long Branch (17:53); 7. Bob Nolan, United A.A. (17:53); 8. Harry Nolan, Middletown (17:44); 9. Mike Mirarchi, West Long Branch (17:46); 10. Don Rowe, Freehold (17:46); 11. Hal DeVestern, New Brunswick (17:51); 12. Ed Scullion, U.S. Beach (17:35); 13. Bernie Terhune, Middletown (18:14); 14. Joe Callahan, Bayville (18:16); 15. Ugo Kuhl, Lakewood (18:20); 16. George Kochman, Millrose A.A. (18:31); 17. Tom Hutchison, Asbury Park (18:41); 18. Harold Suggs, Asbury Park (18:43); 19. Bill Such, Middletown (18:49); 20. Jim Busby, United A.A. (18:51); 21. Bill Darnell, Brick Township (18:51); 22. Bill Murray, Middletown (18:51); 23. Bill Goodheart, United A.A. (18:51); 24. Dr. George A. Sheehan Jr., C.I.T.C. (18:51); 25. Gordon Orgler, Neptune (18:51); 26. Ed Tompkins, Brick Township (18:51); 27. Grant Weisbrodt, United A.A. (18:51); 28. Bob Carlson, Brick Township (18:51); 29. Don Sutphin, Bradley Beach (18:51); 30. Bob Kessler, Long Branch (18:51); 31. Alan Berman, Long Branch (18:51).

10-MILE WALK

1. Don Daniel, NYAC (1:23:13); 2. Bob Mimm, Penn. AC (1:23:44); 3. Dr. John Shilling, NY Pioneer Club (1:23:44); 4. Joe Stefanovic, Penn. AC (1:23:44); 5. John Buzsacki, New York City (1:23:44); 6. Elliott Denman, Pioneer Club (1:23:44); 7. Lou Stankovich, Long Branch (1:23:44); 8. Kurt Sielner, Pioneer Club (1:23:44); 9. Roy Rankin, Penn. AC (1:23:44); 10. Eric Walte, Penn. AC (1:23:44); 11. Sam Monastero, Penn. AC (1:23:44); 12. John Abbate, Penn. AC (1:23:44); 13. Tom Radlovacki, Penn. AC (1:23:44); 14. Kenneth Elth, South Jersey T.C. (1:23:44); 15. Bob Lynch, Brick Township (1:23:44); 16. Fred Spector, Lakewood (1:23:44); 17. Ed Tompkins, Brick Township (1:23:44); 18. Team: Penn. A.C. (1:23:44) 10 pts.; N. Y. Pioneer Club (1:23:44) 11 pts.



Asbury Park Councilman Frank H. Rowland presents trophy to top finisher, Don Daniel, representing the New York Pioneer Club.

THANK YOU TO OUR SPONSORS

